

Question:

At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

At birth, the human brain is still developing and maturing, but certain parts of it are more developed than others. The visual system, which is responsible for processing visual information, is relatively well-developed at birth, as newborns can respond to light and distinguish between light and dark. The thalamus, which serves as a relay station for sensory and motor signals to the cerebral cortex, is also well-developed. The brain stem, which controls basic functions like breathing, heart rate, and blood pressure, is crucial for survival and is relatively mature at birth. The other options, such as the frontal lobe, parietal lobe, cerebellum, basal ganglia, hypothalamus, and limbic system, are also essential for various functions, including motor control, memory, and emotions. However, these parts continue to mature and develop rapidly after birth. Considering the developmental stage of these parts at birth, the least developed part is the one that requires the most maturation and experience for its full function. Among the options provided, the part that is relatively underdeveloped at birth is the cortex, as it is responsible for higher-order functions like thought, action, and perception, which mature gradually over time. Therefore, the part of the brain that is least developed at birth is the cortex. </think><answer> G. cortex </answer>